you exactly what is affecting your sleep, this isn't quite there yet.

HRV NUMBERS

HRV is probably the feature that made me think the most about how health data should actually be presented to consumers. During my testing, the Maxfit reported HRV values in the low 20s, ranging from around 21ms to 25ms. When I compared that with my Apple Watch Series 12, the Apple Watch was showing readings around 50ms.

HRV isn't a universal number that should be compared blindly across different devices. Measurement methods, timing and algorithms can all affect the result. So I wouldn't call the Maxfit's reading inaccurate because it was lower.

But there is another problem: context. If I had been wearing only the Maxfit, seeing an HRV value in the low 20s could have been quite concerning. The app does show the HRV pattern, but my readings remained around the 20ms range and there wasn't enough explanation to tell me what that number actually meant for my recovery.

This is where I think Ubon needs to do more. Health wearables are increasingly becoming devices that influence how people think about their bodies. If a device is going to tell me that my recovery is poor or my stress is high, it needs to explain the data rather than simply displaying a number.

HEART RATE TRACKING

Heart rate was a different story. For normal day-to-day activity and resting heart rate, the Maxfit was surprisingly close to my Apple Watch Series 12. The two generally went hand in hand, which was reassuring. I did notice more differences during exercise, however. The Maxfit's heart-rate readings weren't always as close to the Apple Watch when I was actively working out.





The same mixed experience extended to the other basic metrics. Blood oxygen readings were broadly similar between the two devices, while step counts and calories were close but not perfect.

During a roughly 2,000-step walk, the difference between the Maxfit and Apple Watch was around 200 steps. That's not disastrous for a casual fitness tracker, but I expected better considering the Maxfit's entire proposition revolves around collecting fitness data.

BATTERY

Ubon claims up to 30 days of active battery life and up to 60 days of standby time. I obviously couldn't validate the full 30-day claim within a review period, but my real-world results were good. I started my testing at 100 per cent, and after roughly a week of use, the battery was down to 48 per cent. I also found charging to be reasonable. After plugging the Maxfit into my laptop for around 20 to 25 minutes, the battery increased to 68 per cent.

This is exactly where removing the screen makes sense. You don't have an AMOLED panel constantly consuming power, so the Maxfit can concentrate on collecting fitness and health data rather than powering a display.

VERDICT

At around Rs 6,000, the Ubon SW-211 Maxfit finds itself in an interesting spot. It is not trying to be another smartwatch, and that is its biggest strength. The screenless design is refreshing, the battery life is impressive, and the Da Halo app gives you an overview of sleep, activity, heart rate, HRV and recovery without forcing you into a subscription. For someone who wants a wearable that tracks their day without becoming another source of notifications, there is something appealing here.

However, I expected the tracking to be more convincing. The HRV readings were consistently much lower than what I saw on my Apple Watch Series 12, the stress score rarely felt believable, sleep tracking lacked useful context and workout data was fairly basic.

– Ashish Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Active Battery life: Upto 30 days | Running time: Upto 30 Hours | Heart Rate: HRV and continuous heart-rate monitoring | Blood Oxygen: SpO2 Monitoring | Wellness tracking: Stress monitoring and advanced sleep tracking | Sports modes: 100+ sports modes (Indoor and outdoor, strength training, running, cycling, etc) | Daily trackers: Step counter, distance and calorie burn | Supported OS: Android and iOS | Alerts: Call, SMS, App notifications vibration/LED

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